

Both Connor and Elysia like to watch their digital creations on the family room entertainment centre. Connor copies his movie creations from the PC hard disk to the camcorder using 1394, then connects the camcorder to the family room TV with an analogue cable. Elysia copies her digital pictures to a memory card and inserts it into the camera, then connects the digital camera to the TV with an analogue cable. Of course, the CD-R creations they just carry from room to room, or to the car.

Both Connor and Elysia are happy that they can do these things, but they also feel that they should be able to have instant access to any content from any room, as soon as that content is created or brought into the house. One day Connor went to the local computer store and purchased a wireless home network kit and another PC. He connected the new PC to the family room TV and to one of the wireless access points. He connected the other access point to the other PC where all the audio, movies, and pictures are stored.

At first Elysia was very enthusiastic about Connor's project - but then came demonstration time. Connor used shared folders to publish the audio, video, and pictures on their wireless home network. When Connor demonstrated how to play audio from the PC, Elysia noticed that sometimes the audio would break up. Then, Connor demonstrated going to the shared video folder and playing a home movie. At this point, both Connor and Elysia were surprised. The video was very choppy and unsatisfying.

Elysia then asked how much this experiment cost. When Connor told her, she was very unhappy. "The old way may not be the most convenient, but at least it works!" And that's exactly what she returned to doing. What Connor didn't know is that his personally designed end-to-end wireless solution did not account for the special needs of digital audio/video streaming. Connor's initial home network attempt remains in operation - when Connor is at the controls. But Connor continues to search for interoperable products and solutions that fulfil the promise of home entertainment networking.